

PF 05: Personal Site and DNS Walkthrough

Live URL

<https://portfolio-six-lake-33.vercel.app>

Live over HTTPS on Vercel's free Hobby tier. A rename to a cleaner project name was attempted; Vercel's project rename did not cascade to the live domain automatically. This URL is the confirmed working deliverable link for now, a cleaner subdomain will be revisited separately from this submission.

DNS Walkthrough

A CNAME record is a single line in a domain's DNS settings that says one name is really just an alias for another name. It does not run any logic or check anything itself, it is just a forwarding note: requests for this name should actually go look up that other name instead.

For my site, the CNAME record will hold a value pointing my custom domain, once I have one, to my Vercel deployment, something like `adrianovwigho.com` pointing to `adrianovwigho.vercel.app`.

Here is what actually happens when someone types my address into a browser:

1. The browser asks a resolver, usually run by the person's internet provider or a public service like Google's, where does this name go?
2. The resolver does not know on its own, so it asks the nameservers for that domain. The nameservers are the official record keepers that hold the real DNS records.
3. The nameserver returns my CNAME record, which points to my Vercel address instead of a final destination.
4. Since a CNAME just points to another name, not a raw address, the resolver has to look that new name up too, one more hop.
5. Eventually the chain resolves to an actual server address, and the resolver hands that back to the browser.
6. The browser connects directly to that address, Vercel's server answers, and my page loads.

This is a chain of one time lookups, not a retry loop. Nothing in the process checks whether the destination exists before allowing a lookup to happen, and there is no repeated searching, each step asks once and either gets an answer pointing further along the chain or gets the final address.